Tome Vault Setup Guide

Run the vault on your Raspberry Pi, open it to friends anywhere with Tailscale Funnel, and install the Android app.

1. Make the repo public

Your friends download the app from your GitHub repo, and the app checks it for updates, so it has to be public. It only holds the app's code, never your books. On GitHub open **https://github.com/xXxHekticxXx/Tome-Vault**, then **Settings** → scroll to **Danger Zone** → **Change visibility** → **Public**.

2. Install the vault on the Pi

On the Pi (over SSH or its own terminal):

```
git clone https://github.com/xXxHekticxXx/Tome-Vault.git ~/tome-vault
cd ~/tome-vault/server
python3 server.py --password YOUR_KEEPER_PASSWORD
python3 server.py --party-password YOUR_PARTY_PASSWORD
```

The **keeper password** is yours alone: it adds, renames, and removes books. The **party password** is what you give friends so they can read.

Start it automatically when the Pi boots

Create the service file:

```
sudo nano /etc/systemd/system/tome-vault.service
```

Paste this in, replacing **YOURUSER** (3 places) with your Pi username. Save with Ctrl+O, Enter, then Ctrl+X.

```
[Unit]
Description=Tome Vault
After=network-online.target
Wants=network-online.target

[Service]
User=YOURUSER
WorkingDirectory=/home/YOURUSER/tome-vault/server
ExecStart=/usr/bin/python3 /home/YOURUSER/tome-vault/server/server.py
Restart=always

[Install]
WantedBy=multi-user.target

sudo systemctl daemon-reload
sudo systemctl enable --now tome-vault
systemctl status tome-vault
```

Look for **active (running)** in green. Press Q to get back to the prompt.

3. Open it to friends with Tailscale Funnel

Funnel gives the Pi a permanent https address on the internet. Friends need nothing but the app.

```
curl -fsSL https://tailscale.com/install.sh | sh
sudo tailscale up
sudo tailscale funnel --bg 8080
tailscale funnel status
```

1. **tailscale up** prints a sign-in link. Open it on any device and create your free Tailscale account.
2. The first time you run **tailscale funnel**, it may print another link to turn Funnel on for your account. Open it, approve, then run the funnel command again.
3. **tailscale funnel status** shows your vault's address. It looks like **https://raspberrypi.tail1234.ts.net**. Write it down; this is what friends enter in the app.
4. Test it: turn off Wi-Fi on your phone and open that address in Chrome. You should see the Tome Vault party password screen.

Funnel stays on through reboots. To shut public access off: **sudo tailscale funnel --bg off**

4. Install the app

1. On your Android phone, open **https://github.com/xXxHekticxXx/Tome-Vault/releases/latest**.
2. Tap **TomeVault.apk** to download it, then open the download.
3. Android asks to allow installs from Chrome the first time. Allow it, then tap **Install**.
4. Open Tome Vault, enter the vault address from step 3 and the party password, then tap **Connect**.
5. Every book downloads to the phone automatically. After that they open even with no signal.

Send friends the release link, the vault address, and the party password. That's everything they need.

Skip the address for friends (optional): in your GitHub repo go to **Settings** → **Secrets and variables** → **Actions** → **Variables**, add a variable named **VAULT_ADDRESS** with your vault address, then open the **Actions** tab and re-run **Build Android app**. New installs will only ask for the party password.

5. Adding books

1. In the app (or in a browser at the vault address), tap the gear icon for **Settings**.
2. Under **Keeper tools**, enter your keeper password and tap **Unlock**.
3. Close Settings and tap **Add a PDF** on the shelf. Pick one or more PDFs.
4. Each friend's app picks up new books the next time they open it, or right away when they tap the refresh button.

Big books go faster from your laptop's browser than from your phone, because the device reads every page to build the search index.

6. Everyday commands (Pi)

```
sudo systemctl restart tome-vault       # restart the vault
```

```
sudo systemctl stop tome-vault          # stop it
systemctl status tome-vault             # is it running?
journalctl -u tome-vault -f             # watch the log (Ctrl+C to exit)
tailscale funnel status                 # show the public address

# change a password, then restart
cd ~/tome-vault/server
python3 server.py --password NEW_KEEPER_PASSWORD
python3 server.py --party-password NEW_PARTY_PASSWORD
sudo systemctl restart tome-vault

# update the vault to the newest version from GitHub
cd ~/tome-vault && git pull && sudo systemctl restart tome-vault

# back up every book to a USB drive
cp -r ~/tome-vault/server/library /media/YOURUSER/USBNAME/
```

7. Good to know

- Changing the party password logs everyone out. Their apps will ask for the new one and keep their downloaded books.
- All books live in **server/library**. Copy that folder and you've backed up the whole vault.
- Scanned PDFs that are only page photos have no text, so they won't appear in search. They still open and read fine.
- Each phone stores a full copy of the library. A big library can take several GB; friends can turn offline copies off in Settings.
- The vault is public through Funnel, so use a party password that isn't easy to guess.